later describe how CHM Saudagar Singh, after grappling with a Chinese soldier, snatched his AK-47 and shot five enemy soldiers before being overpowered.

After the lifting of the artillery fire, the company commander, Captain Ravi Eipe, decided to move up to the Assam Rifles post to get a better picture of what was happening. Moving through Saudagar's No. 2 Platoon, Eipe began climbing towards the Assam Rifles post with his runner where he was greeted by a barrage of small arms fire. Thinking that the Assam Rifles were shooting at them, Eipe shouted to them to hold their fire. Only then did he realize that the troops milling around in the Assam Rifles post were wearing the khaki uniforms of the Chinese. Doubling back, he asked No. 2 Platoon to readjust their positions and face uphill.

Describing the subsequent attack, Eipe says: 'In a short while the Chinese started attacking in skirmish order from the westerly direction towards No. 2 Platoon. Meanwhile No. 2 Platoon had reorganized itself and started taking a heavy toll on the Chinese coming towards the post.' The fighting was bitter, with Saudagar Singh fighting bravely, inspiring the men lying in the shallow communication trenches and behind boulders to keep on fighting. In the meantime, a runner brought the news that Subedar Ghanshyam Singh had been killed. Eipe recalled: 'I told Subedar Phool Singh (company second-in-command) to go to No. 3 Platoon and take over command. At the same time I saw the Chinese outflanking No. 2 Platoon from the west and going towards No. 1 Platoon on the river line.'

At about 7 a.m. the Chinese started engaging Subedar Basdeo Singh's position. The platoon was expecting the attack and there was a barrage of gunfire as both sides opened up. Though attacked from two sides, the platoon held its own and beat back the first few assaults. Fifteen minutes later, the Chinese reassembled and flowed down from the Assam Rifles post and assaulted No. 3 Platoon. Though the men fought grittily, their numbers were depleted as casualties steadily mounted. Though cut off from No. 1 Platoon, Captain Eipe, wounded by a mortar splinter, decided to pull out with the remnants of No. 2 and No. 3 Platoon and try and move along the Rongla Nullah towards Brigade HQ. By this time the panicky runaways from Bridge 4 also arrived at Basdeo's position by the river. The rest of No. 1 Platoon then extricated itself and joined the exodus. Despite the withdrawal, Alpha Company lost more than half its men.